

this musical language into his own compositions. From about 1879, too, he started transcribing the intonations of speech. In 1909, he acquired an Edison phonograph, which he used to record folk song, much as Bartók did in Hungary.

Janáček's influences from opera and the concert hall included Smetana, Dvořák, and Tchaikovsky—but he detested Wagner. He developed his own operas in a highly individual direction, using speech patterns (see box). He often based works on Russian literature; his first string quartet is modeled on Tolstoy's *The Kreutzer Sonata*, and two of his operas, *Katya Kabanová* and *From the House of the Dead*, on Ostrovsky and Dostoyevsky respectively.